

The key to shopping from these sites is to keep the transaction value as low as possible. If the value of the imported product goes above Rs 2000, which is the legal limit for duty free imports, the shipment is very likely to be scrutinized for import duty check. While you might be willing to pay the duty levied on the product, the duty assessment process can cause an unnecessary delay. International sites should be generally used to import low-cost accessories and components that are generally not available in India or are horribly over-priced in the local market. While some international sites do offer warranty, the expense related to shipping the product back to the vendor and the possible delays in resolution can get frustrating. So, it is recommended that you stick to accessories like cases, cables and some of the unique products that are only available internationally. A portable charging bank for iPod/iPad is a good example of a unique product that sells for a mere \$8 on www.dealextreme.com

<http://www.dealextreme.com/p/universal-portable-2600mah-power-bank-for-ipad-iphone-ipod-mp3-mp4-more-black-150528>

Examples of sites that ship to India

www.dealextreme.com

<http://www.abacus24-7.com/>

Ordering through shipping companies

The concept of being able to buy imported products without any hassles gives rise to enough opportunities for business and hence, apart from online stores, you have shipping companies offering the same services via a special account. Aramex, a shipping and logistics service provider offers a “Shop and Ship” account – its e-tail delivery service offers Middle Eastern and Indian consumers the convenience of online shopping from the US, the UK and Europe at competitive rates. Shoppers can access the Aramex service by logging on to ShopandShip.com and signing up for a lifetime membership account which costs \$45 (₹ 2,230). Once the consumer places an order, Aramex receives the ordered goods at its facilities from the e-tailer, and then ships and delivers them right to the doorstep of the shopper. Here again, the service provider adds customs duties and shipping service charges over and above the final product price that you pay with your credit card.

Unlike eBay Global Easy Buy, this service doesn't have any robust buyer protection mechanism; you have to trust the service provider to get you